PRINCE2 | P2-10

Project Initiation Documentation

The baselined "what, why, who, how, when and how much" of the project

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Project Initiation Documentation
Document reference	*P2-10-HEL-T2-v1.0*
Project / Programme	*Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build*
Version	*1.0*
Status	*Baselined*
Date	*18 Sep 2026*
Author	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*
Owner	*Project Manager*
Approver	*Project Board (Authorise the Project)*
Classification	*Internal*
Retention	*7 years from programme closure*

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	*04 Jun 2026*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Initial draft*
0.2	*21 Jul 2026*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Updated following workstream lead review*
1.0	*18 Sep 2026*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate*

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	*Chief Platform Architect*	*Technical content and solution alignment*	*08 Sep 2026*
L. Haddad, CISO	*CISO*	*Security, assurance and residency content*	*10 Sep 2026*
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	*Finance Business Partner*	*Cost, funding and benefit figures*	*11 Sep 2026*
M. Verity, Head of P3O	*Head of P3O*	*Governance standards and completeness*	*15 Sep 2026*

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	*Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO*	*Approved*	*18 Sep 2026*
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	*Director of Infrastructure*	*Approved*	*18 Sep 2026*
L. Haddad, CISO	*CISO*	*Approved subject to closure of ISS-003*	*18 Sep 2026*

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
P2-02	Project Brief	Source
P2-03	Project Product Description	Component
P2-04	Business Case	Component
P2-05	Benefits Management Approach	Component
P2-06	Risk Management Approach	Component

Reference	Product	Relationship
P2-07	Quality Management Approach	Component
P2-08	Change Control Approach	Component
P2-09	Communication Management Approach	Component
P2-11	Plan	Project Plan is a component

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Assembles the key information needed to start the project on a sound basis, conveys that information to all concerned, and acts as the baseline against which progress and success are judged.
Framework	PRINCE2 — Assembled in Initiating a Project; baselined at Authorise the Project; updated at each stage boundary
Created when	Initiating a Project
Reviewed / updated	At each stage boundary — the current version is the live baseline
Owner	Project Manager
Approver	Project Board (Authorise the Project)
Format options	A single document, a set of linked documents, or a collection of records in a project management tool.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- It is not simply the Project Brief reissued — it demonstrably develops it
- It is accurate, complete and internally consistent across all components
- The whole project can be understood from it by someone not previously involved
- Component approaches are consistent with one another and with corporate standards
- Tolerances are set at every level and the escalation route is clear

Contents

1. Project definition

Carried forward from the Project Brief and refined: background, objectives, desired outcomes, scope and exclusions, constraints, assumptions, users and interested parties, interfaces.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Reviewed monthly at the Programme Board. Detail is maintained by the Project Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

2. Project approach

The confirmed delivery approach, including any decisions made since the brief.

Delivery is phased into three tranches, each ending with a formal review and a funding gate. Facilities and hardware workstreams follow a predictive approach with design freeze points, because their lead times and physical dependencies do not tolerate emerging requirements. The platform, MLOps and security workstreams run on a quarterly planning interval with an Agile Release Train, because their requirements are genuinely emergent and the feedback loop from researchers is short.

3. Business Case

Insert the detailed Business Case (P2-04) or reference it as a companion document.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Reported through the monthly benefit tracking report. Detail is maintained by the Project Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

4. Project management team structure and role descriptions

Organisation chart

Insert chart showing Project Board, Project Manager, Team Managers, Project Assurance, Change Authority and Project Support.

Appointments

Role	Name	Organisation	Time commitment	Confirmed
Executive	*H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure*	*H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure*	*H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure*	*H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure*
Senior User	*J. Ferreira, Network Lead*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*Developer pushes to the platform monorepo; pre-commit hooks run secret scanning*	*25 Jun 2027*
Senior Supplier	*B. Oyelaran, Quality and Assurance Lead*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*Developer pushes to the platform monorepo; pre-commit hooks run secret scanning*	*25 Jun 2027*
Project Manager	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*
Team Manager	*D. Okonkwo, Release*	*Group Technology —*	*Developer pushes*	*15 Dec 2026*

Role	Name	Organisation	Time commitment	Confirmed
	Train Engineer	*Infrastructure and Platform*	*to the platform monorepo; pre-commit hooks run secret scanning*	
Project Assurance	*T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*Developer pushes to the platform monorepo; pre-commit hooks run secret scanning*	*30 Nov 2026*
Change Authority	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*
Project Support	*V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*Developer pushes to the platform monorepo; pre-commit hooks run secret scanning*	*18 Sep 2026*

5. Quality Management Approach

Insert or reference P2-07.

Delivery is phased into three tranches, each ending with a formal review and a funding gate. Facilities and hardware workstreams follow a predictive approach with design freeze points, because their lead times and physical dependencies do not tolerate emerging requirements. The platform, MLOps and security workstreams run on a quarterly planning interval with an Agile Release Train, because their requirements are genuinely emergent and the feedback loop from researchers is short.

6. Change Control Approach

Insert or reference P2-08.

Delivery is phased into three tranches, each ending with a formal review and a funding gate. Facilities and hardware workstreams follow a predictive approach with design freeze points, because their lead times and physical dependencies do not tolerate emerging requirements. The platform, MLOps and security workstreams run on a quarterly planning interval with an Agile Release Train, because their requirements are genuinely emergent and the feedback loop from researchers is short.

7. Risk Management Approach

Insert or reference P2-06.

Delivery is phased into three tranches, each ending with a formal review and a funding gate. Facilities and hardware workstreams follow a predictive approach with design freeze points, because their lead times and physical dependencies do not tolerate emerging requirements. The platform, MLOps and security workstreams run on a quarterly planning interval with an Agile Release Train, because their requirements are genuinely emergent and the feedback loop from researchers is short.

8. Communication Management Approach

Insert or reference P2-09.

Delivery is phased into three tranches, each ending with a formal review and a funding gate. Facilities and hardware workstreams follow a predictive approach with design freeze points, because their lead times and physical dependencies do not tolerate emerging requirements. The platform, MLOps and security workstreams run on a quarterly planning interval with an Agile Release Train, because their requirements are genuinely emergent and the feedback loop from researchers is short.

9. Project Plan

Insert or reference the Project Plan (P2-11), including the product breakdown structure, product flow diagram, schedule, budget and stage boundaries.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026. Detail is maintained by the Project Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

10. Project controls

Stage structure

Stage	Purpose	Start	End	Key products
Tranche 1	*Foundation — 256-GPU pilot cluster in DXB-1, proving power, cooling and fabric design*	*15 Dec 2026*	*31 Jan 2027*	*Operations runbook set with two completed live drills*
Tranche 2	*Scale — 2,048 GPUs across DXB-1 halls A and B, production platform and MLOps stack*	*31 Jan 2027*	*26 Feb 2027*	*Independent security assurance report with findings closed*
Tranche 3	*Multi-tenancy and resilience — 4,096 GPUs, AUH-2 second site, chargeback and DR*	*26 Feb 2027*	*31 Mar 2027*	*400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated*

Reporting and review controls

Control	Frequency	Owner	Recipient
Checkpoint Report	*Weekly*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*F. Mansour, Business Change Lead*
Highlight Report	*Significant impact with a workaround available — response within one working day*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Significant impact with a workaround available — response within one working day*
End Stage Report / assessment	*Tranche 2 — Scale build*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Tranche 2 — Scale build*
Exception process	*Each iteration*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead*
Project Board meeting	*At each stage*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme*	*WS4 Platform and*

Control	Frequency	Owner	Recipient
	boundary	*Manager*	*orchestration*

Escalation route

How exceptions travel from Team Manager to Project Manager to Project Board to corporate/programme management.

11. Tailoring of PRINCE2 for this project

Record what has been tailored, why, and what the resulting risk is. Tailoring must be a conscious, recorded decision — not a silent omission.

Element	Standard approach	Tailored approach	Rationale	Risk accepted
Parallel filesystem tier of 12 PB usable sustaining 1.2 TB/s to the compute estate	*Enforced automatically in the pipeline; manual assertion is not accepted as evidence*	*Combined with the adjacent product to reduce document count*	*Physical lead times do not tolerate emerging requirements, so this element is frozen before order*	*Vendor allocation slippage defers the Tranche 2 benefit by a quarter (RSK-001)*
Signed container image supply chain with admission enforcement and firmware attestation	*Reviewed at each end-of-tranche review and updated by change control only*	*Applied in full*	*Grid capacity at DXB-1 supports Tranche 2 in full, so a second site is not yet justified*	*Scarce platform engineering skills extend contractor dependence (RSK-004)*
400G RoCEv2 leaf-spine fabric tuned for collective communication at 256-GPU job scale	*Delegated to the Programme Manager within tolerance; above tolerance to the Programme Board*	*Not used — recorded in the tailoring decision record*	*Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point*	*Vendor allocation slippage defers the Tranche 2 benefit by a quarter (RSK-001)*
Liquid-cooled racks at 60 kW with rear-door heat exchangers and CDU redundancy at N+1	*Applies to all workloads on the DXB-1 estate without exception*	*Replaced by the equivalent record in the ALM tool*	*Consolidation is the primary source of the benefit case; utilisation across siloed estates averages 31%*	*Hall B cooling capacity limits achievable rack density (RSK-002)*

12. Tolerances

Level	Time	Cost	Scope	Quality	Risk	Benefit
Project (set by corporate)	*AED 11,200,000*	*AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5%*	*In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B,*	*No open critical or high security findings; acceptance*	*No individual risk may remain above a residual*	*No more than 10% variance against the benefit*

Level	Time	Cost	Scope	Quality	Risk	Benefit
		before escalation	*the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.*	*benchmarks met in full*	*score of 12 without SRO acceptance*	*profile before escalation*
Stage (set by Board)	*Tranche 2 — Scale build*	*Tranche 2 — Scale build*	*Tranche 2 — Scale build*	*Tranche 2 — Scale build*	*Tranche 2 — Scale build*	*Tranche 2 — Scale build*
Work Package (set by PM)	*90 days*	*AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation*	*In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and*	*No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full*	*No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance*	*No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation*

Level	Time	Cost	Scope	Quality	Risk	Benefit
			developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.			